CRIME & NEIGHBORHOOD WATCH

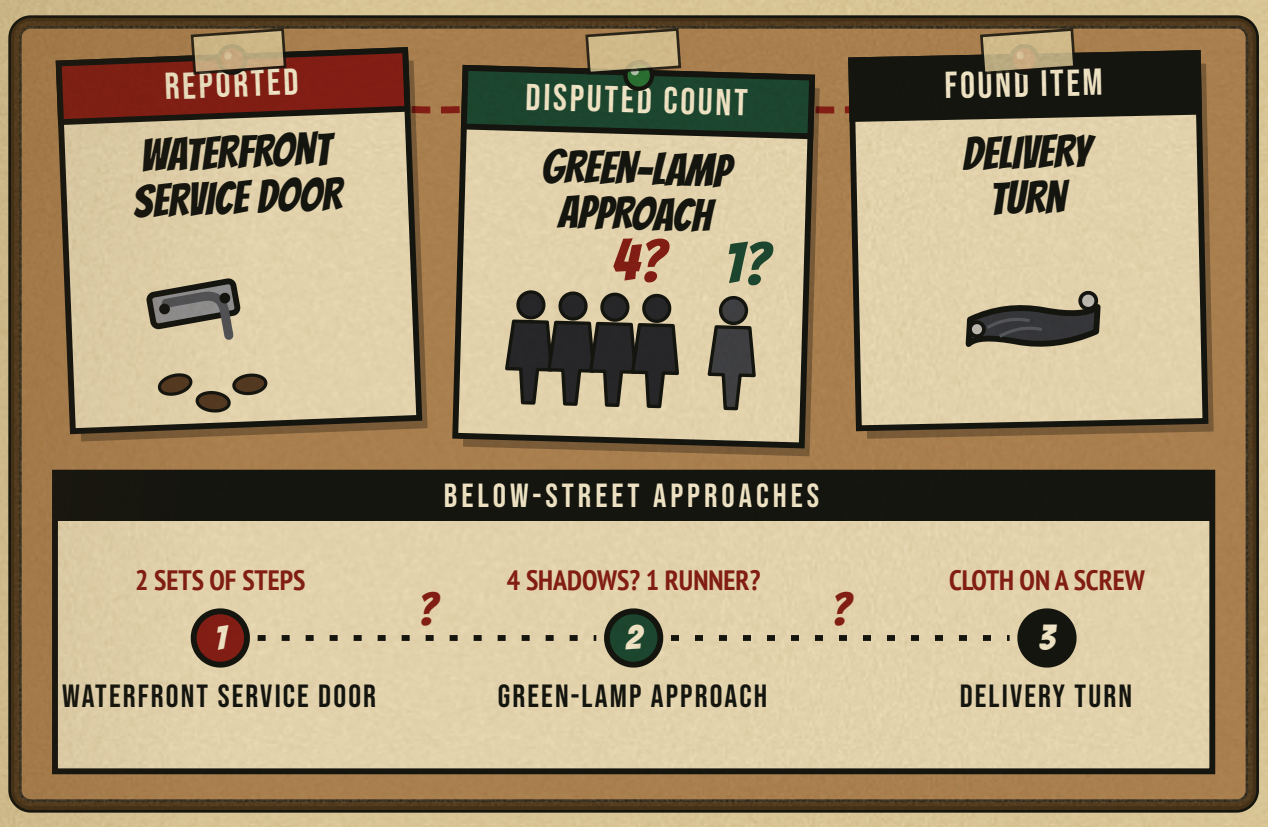
REPORTED | DISPUTED | FOUND ITEM

THE DESK COMPARED THE ACCOUNTS WITHOUT TURNING RESEMBLANCE INTO CERTAINTY

THREE CORRIDORS, NO SINGLE STORY

UNCONFIRMED

Reports of damaged locks and coordinated movement overlap. The witnesses do not. The Underground Press compared their accounts without turning resemblance into certainty.



INCIDENT LEDGER

WATERFRONT SERVICE DOOR — REPORTED. Bent latch; two sets of steps heard; three muddy marks observed later. No confirmed loss. Source withheld.

GREEN-LAMP APPROACH — DISPUTED COUNT. One witness described four moving figures; another heard one runner. Fog limited sightlines. No faces reported.

DELIVERY TURN — FOUND ITEM. Strip of common dark work cloth recovered from a screw beside a repaired lock. No insignia and no confirmed owner.

Three below-street approaches appear repeatedly in the reports collected for Issue 001: a waterfront service door, the green-lamp approach, and a delivery turn used after closing. The descriptions overlap at the edges—dark clothing, quick movement, little conversation—but none supplies a clear face, name, or shared destination.

A shopkeeper near the waterfront said a rear latch was bent inward sometime after the last delivery. The shopkeeper heard two sets of steps and later found three muddy marks. "That does not make three people," the shopkeeper said. "It makes three marks." Nothing was reported missing.

At the green-lamp approach, a cart puller saw "four shadows moving like they had practiced." Fog and a low lamp shortened the view. The puller could not say whether the figures entered a restricted passage or simply crossed in front of it. A second neighbor at the same approach heard only one runner.

The delivery-turn report is stranger and less complete. A folded strip of dark cloth was found caught on a screw beside a recently repaired lock. The material is common work cloth. It bears no insignia. Two residents independently used the name "Foot Clan" after hearing about it; neither claimed direct knowledge. The newsroom has not confirmed that such a group caused these incidents—or that the name identifies a real organization at all.

What can be said is narrower. Several neighbors changed closing routines. Volunteer latch checks found ordinary wear as well as deliberate-looking damage, and the difference was not always obvious. Late delivery riders report more paired travel. The Crust Bucket's unusual midnight orders occurred near the same broad set of passages, but an order pattern is not an identification.

The desk will continue comparing times, descriptions, and physical traces. For now, neighbors should record what they directly saw or heard, distinguish it from what somebody else repeated, and avoid following unidentified people into restricted corridors. Suspicion is not a public service unless it stays honest about its limits.

WHAT WE KNOW / WHAT WE DO NOT

CONFIRMED

✓ Neighbors filed multiple accounts.

✓ Several latches were damaged or worn.

✓ Closing routines changed.

UNCONFIRMED

? A single group caused every incident.

? The black clothing matches.

? "Foot Clan" names an organization.

? Pizza orders identify anybody involved.

WATCH DESK

- ▸ Write the time first.
- ▸ Separate sight from sound.
- ▸ Describe clothing without guessing identity.
- ▸ Do not enter a restricted passage to improve a story.
- ▸ Leave anonymous notes at the staffed press drop.

THREE MARKS ARE NOT THREE PEOPLE.

WE'RE ALL LOOKING FOR A PLACE TO LAND.